With Spring Data JDBC, you can enable auditing for all the persistent entities using the `@EnableJdbcAuditing` annotation on a configuration class. In the `com.polarbookshop.catalogservice.config` package, add a `DataConfig` class to gather JDBC-related configuration.

Listing 5.9 Enabling JDBC auditing via annotation configuration

```
package com.polarbookshop.catalogservice.config;

import org.springframework.context.annotation.Configuration;
import org.springframework.data.jdbc.repository.config.EnableJdbcAuditing;

@Configuration                    ❶
@EnableJdbcAuditing               ❷
public class DataConfig {}
```

❶ Indicates a class as a source of Spring configuration

❷ Enables auditing for persistent entities

NOTE In Spring Data JPA, you would use the `@EnableJpaAuditing` annotation to enable JPA auditing, and you would annotate the entity class with `@EntityListeners(AuditingEntityListener.class)` to make it listen to audit events, which doesn't happen automatically as in Spring Data JDBC.

When this feature is enabled, audit events are generated whenever data is created, updated, or deleted. Spring Data provides convenient annotations (listed in table 5.1) that we can use on dedicated fields to capture the information from such events (*audit metadata*) and store it in the database as part of the entity.

Table 5.1 When database auditing is enabled, these annotations can be used on entity fields to capture audit metadata.